You can *write this.*

How to plan, write and check the email, the article and the story, so you don’t lose easy marks.

Two tasks · 45 minutes · about 100 words each

THE PAPER AT A GLANCE

No. 02

What you get on the day

2

tasks: the email, then your choice of an article or a story

45

minutes: roughly 20 per task, plus a few to check

100

words per task. A bit over is fine. Don’t go far under.

40

marks: each task is worth 20

Everyone writes the email. In Part 2 you pick the one you like better.

HOW YOU ARE MARKED

No. 03

What the examiner is looking for

0–5 MARKS

Content

Did you do what the task asked? All of it?

0–5 MARKS

Communicative Achievement

Does it sound like an email to a friend, or a letter to the bank? Choose the right one.

0–5 MARKS

Organisation

Paragraphs and linking words, so the reader never gets lost.

0–5 MARKS

Language

Don’t use “nice” four times. Show off a little and try a longer sentence.

Four notes, four answers

1. Read the email twice. Who’s writing, and what do they want?
2. Find the four notes. Each one is a small question you must answer.
3. Plan one short paragraph per note. Thirty seconds, no more.
4. Say hello and goodbye properly: *Hi Jude, … See you soon, Maria.*
5. Don’t just answer. Say why, or give an example.
6. Count your notes (four!), then your words, then check spelling.

From: Jude · Subject: Our class trip

Our class trip is next month!

Me too!

Should we go by bus or by train?

Explain which is better

What should we take with us?

Suggest…

Can you help with the food on Saturday?

No, because…

Steal these phrases

Suggesting

- How about + -ing?
- Why don’t we…?
- Let’s…
- Shall we…?

Preferring

- I’d rather…
- I prefer X to Y.
- I’m not keen on…
- X is better because…

Reasons

- because + verb
- as / since + verb
- because of + noun
- in case…

Open & close

- Hi Sam,
- Thanks for your email!
- See you soon,
- Best wishes,

Don’t copy whole sentences from Jude’s email. Say it your way.

Maria’s reply, with notes

Hi Jude,

Thanks for your email! I’d love to come on the trip too. I’ve never been to the mountains, so I’m really excited.

I think the train is better than the bus because it’s faster and more comfortable. We can walk around, and the views from the window are amazing.

How about taking sandwiches and a warm jacket? It might be cold in the evening.

I’m sorry, but I can’t help with the food on Saturday because I have a football match. Maybe Ana can do it?

See you soon,

Maria

01

Hello, goodbye and her name each get their own line.

02

One note, one paragraph. Easy to follow.

03

She never just says yes or no. There’s always a “because”.

04

Just under 100 words, and every note is answered.

Article *or* story.

You only write one. Read both, then pick the one that feels easier.

Tell them what you think, and why

1. Underline every question in the notice. You have to answer all of them.
2. Say what you think, clearly: *I really believe…*, *For me…*
3. Every opinion needs a reason. Better still, an example.
4. Use your own life. It’s easier to write, and nicer to read.
5. Don’t copy the question. Say it your way.
6. Give it a title, and finish with your opinion again.

THE FORMULA

Opinion
I think… / In my opinion…

+ Reason
because… / so…

+ Example
for example… / such as…

Their first line, your story

1. Copy the first sentence exactly. If it says “I”, you’re the hero.
2. Plan the start, the problem and the ending before you write.
3. Tell us how the character feels. Scared? Relieved? Furious?
4. Join your sentences: *when, as soon as, suddenly, in the end.*
5. A surprise ending is great, but only if it makes sense.

Three past tenses

PAST SIMPLE · EVENTS

I opened the door.

PAST CONTINUOUS · BACKGROUND

It was raining hard.

PAST PERFECT · BEFORE THAT

Someone had left a note.

Which one should you pick?

Choose the *article* if…

- you have strong opinions on the topic
- you know the words for it
- reasons come to you quickly

Choose the *story* if…

- past tenses don’t scare you
- you can already see an ending
- you like describing feelings

Practise both at home. On the day, read both tasks and go with your gut.

BEFORE YOU FINISH

Five minutes to save marks

- Every note or question answered?
- Hello and goodbye on their own lines?
- Past tenses right? (*went*, not *goed*)
- Paragraphs?
- Linking words: *because, so, however, then*?
- About 100 words, spelling checked?

If the examiner can’t read your writing, it can’t get marks.

Read the task twice. Then write.

Good luck.